

Carnegie Hall 2027 Family Meeting Packet

Ashley Bands • September 1, 2026

A plain-language record of the opportunity, tonight's commitment, the family cost boundary, cancellation and FRP information, and what happens next.

\$50

OPENS TONIGHT

Conditional deposit due Friday, September 4. It is refundable until the required performer threshold is reached and the WorldStrides group deposit is paid from Booster-held trip funds.

\$2,000

FAMILY CEILING

Under this commitment, Ashley Bands will not ask - and the Boosters are not authorized to collect - more than \$2,000 from a participating family. It is not a bill due tonight.

\$500

OUR GOAL

Ashley Bands will lead the work to move the family total toward \$500 through significant outside support. This is ambitious and is not guaranteed.

The trip is currently planning around \$2,500 per traveler, excluding personal spending. That is an estimate used to build the trip and funding plan, not another family ask.

WHO IS RESPONSIBLE

Four names, four different roles

Ashley Bands The band program builds the educational plan and communicates official trip information to students and families.	Mr. Parker The Director of Bands directs the ensembles, approves performers, and recommends which performance path can move forward.
Ashley High School and NHCS The school and district approve school travel, the authorized signer, supervision, and district requirements.	Ashley High School Band Boosters The Boosters receive family payments through PayPal, maintain the trip ledger, make authorized vendor payments, and issue authorized refunds.

THE OPPORTUNITY

Two Ashley High School ensembles were selected. Now the plan has to become real.

- The Ashley High School Concert Band and Wind Ensemble were selected for the National Band & Orchestra Festival at Carnegie Hall.
- Working travel dates are March 23-26, 2027, with both performances on Thursday, March 25.
- The intended educational plan includes Carnegie performances and an AIM master class, Broadway, Statue of Liberty and Ellis Island, the Empire State Building or another structured activity, charter transportation, three hotel nights, and selected meals.
- The final itemized quote, adult pricing, exact inclusions, and any below-minimum ensemble surcharge are still being finalized.

PARTICIPATION

The trip can move forward in one of two ways

40 + 40

Both ensembles

- At least 40 confirmed Wind Ensemble performers
- At least 40 confirmed Concert Band performers
- Two separate Carnegie performances

50

Wind Ensemble-centered

- At least 50 Mr. Parker-approved performers
- Current Wind Ensemble performers are preapproved
- Concert Band students may be added based on instrumentation and readiness
- An unapproved Concert Band student receives the \$50 deposit back

WHAT TONIGHT MEANS

Serious intent now; final contract next

- The form is an initial family intent acknowledgement with typed parent and student signatures. It is not the final trip contract.
- A serious yes gives Mr. Parker and the Boosters a reliable count for the performance-path and vendor-deposit decisions.
- A family is agreeing that it intends to participate if its total responsibility is no more than \$2,000.
- If the eventual family responsibility would exceed \$2,000, the band program must return to families for a new decision. Tonight's acknowledgement does not authorize the Boosters to collect a higher amount.
- The band program will issue the final participation agreement after the performance-path and vendor-deposit decisions and before the Boosters open the next major family payment.

DATE	WORKING MAXIMUM	MEANING
September 4	\$50	Conditional deposit
September 15	up to \$450	Working first payment
October 15	up to \$500	Working second payment
November 15	up to \$500	Working third payment
December 15	up to \$500	Working final payment

Only the \$50 is open now. The later amounts are a maximum working model and do not become active until the band program issues the final family agreement and the Boosters issue payment instructions. Confirmed outside support can reduce them.

What happens when an individual student withdraws

1 Before the WorldStrides group deposit is paid

The conditional \$50 is refundable. If the required performer threshold is not reached or the trip does not proceed, the Boosters issue the refund under Hannah Hales's authorization.

2 After the Boosters pay the group deposit

The \$50 becomes nonrefundable and remains credited to the student's trip balance. No later family payment should be collected until the final agreement and written withdrawal rules are issued.

3 After final registration

The final family agreement, WorldStrides cancellation bands, and the group's FRP election control the remaining financial result.

Current standard cancellation bands without FRP

CANCELLATION DATE	CURRENT WORLDSTRIDES CONSEQUENCE
Through November 22, 2026	\$225 per person plus other nonrefundable fees
November 23, 2026-January 6, 2027	25% of the program price plus nonrefundable fees
January 7-February 6, 2027	50% of the program price plus nonrefundable fees
February 7, 2027 or later	No refund

These are the current WorldStrides group-billed individual-cancellation bands when FRP has not been elected. WorldStrides sends group-billed refunds to the Program Leader; the Ashley High School Band Boosters then distribute and reconcile family refunds.

OPTIONAL PROTECTION

Full Refund Program (FRP)

Under the current terms, FRP can protect amounts paid when cancellation happens at least one day before departure, minus the FRP enrollment fee and other nonrefundable fees.

WHAT IS KNOWN • The preliminary estimate is \$279 per covered traveler. • The FRP fee becomes nonrefundable after 24 hours. • FRP is not a promise that every dollar, fee, or outside travel arrangement will be returned.	WHAT MR. PARKER AND THE BOOSTERS ARE CONFIRMING • Final family price and FRP election deadline • Whether group billing requires the entire group or permits individual travelers to elect • Exactly which payments collected by the Boosters and which nonrefundable amounts are protected • When the charge must be paid on group 150783
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THE SHARED CAMPAIGN

Moving the family total toward \$500 starts tonight

Moving the family total toward \$500 will require a significant shared campaign beginning tonight. No gift, grant, scholarship, media placement, or lower family total is guaranteed yet.

- Introduce Mr. Parker to an employer, business, corporate partner, foundation, civic group, arts supporter, or major donor.
- Open a door to local media or a community leader who can help tell the Carnegie and seven-year rebuilding story.
- Help with outreach, events, campaign communications, and donor follow-up.
- Respond promptly to deadlines even if your family cannot add volunteer capacity.

Carnegie deposits, payments, and sponsorships stay separate from Marching Band funding goals and program needs.

BEFORE THE FINAL AGREEMENT

These details still require written answers

- Corrected itemized quote, adult pricing, final inclusions, and any ensemble surcharge
- Final family price and payment instructions within the \$2,000 ceiling
- FRP price, election mechanics, deadline, and protected amounts
- Written withdrawal, cancellation, and refund-distribution rules
- School approval, authorized signer, chaperone plan, and economic-access process

PARENT QUESTIONS

Frequently asked questions

Is the trip definitely happening?	Both Ashley High School ensembles have been selected, and Mr. Parker is actively planning. The performer threshold, Ashley High School and NHCS approvals, final agreement, and Booster-funded WorldStrides deposit still have to close.
Why commit before the final price?	Mr. Parker needs a reliable performer count before recommending a performance path, and the Boosters need that count before risking a nonrefundable vendor deposit. Tonight's decision is bounded at a \$2,000 family ceiling with only the conditional \$50 open now.
What if I need to withdraw?	Before the Boosters pay the WorldStrides group deposit, the \$50 is refundable. After that it is nonrefundable. Later payments follow the final agreement and FRP decision.
Does FRP return every dollar?	No. Current terms describe reimbursement of amounts paid minus the FRP fee and other nonrefundable fees. Mr. Parker and the Boosters are confirming the exact group-billed implementation with WorldStrides before offering it.

Frequently asked questions, continued

What if the family responsibility exceeds \$2,000?	Families receive a new decision point. Tonight's acknowledgement does not authorize Ashley Bands to ask - or the Boosters to collect - more than \$2,000 from a family.
Who receives and tracks the money?	The Ashley High School Band Boosters receive the payment through PayPal. Booster President and current Treasurer Hannah Hales owns the trip ledger and refund authorization.
Can fundraising guarantee a \$500 family total?	No. It is the campaign goal, not a promised price. It requires substantial outside support and broad family participation.
When is the final agreement?	The band program will issue it after Mr. Parker confirms the performance path, required school approvals are in place, and the Boosters pay the applicable vendor deposit - and before the next major family payment opens. It will contain the final price, payment schedule, withdrawal rules, cancellation terms, and FRP decision.

DUE FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 4

Give the band program a reliable answer

Complete one response per student. A serious yes creates the connected \$50 conditional-deposit charge and lets the family pay immediately at ashleybands.com/carnegie-2027/commit.

Sources and status

- WorldStrides K12 Group Performing Arts Festivals & Bowl Games/Parades Group Terms and Conditions, revised September 2025
- WorldStrides 2026-27 group-billed payment schedule
- Ashley High School Concert Band and Wind Ensemble acceptance letters, August 24, 2026
- Ashley Bands in-progress Letter of Understanding and preliminary estimate
- Ashley Bands Carnegie Hall 2027 project record, reconciled through September 1, 2026

Planning information as of September 1, 2026. Estimates and open terms are labeled throughout.